Curriculum Vitae — John Hicks

johndanielshicks.github.io

Email: john.hicks@wisc.edu
Mobile: (1) 203-559-0627
Address: 727 Clark Court Madison, WI 53715

Education

- **University of Wisconsin–Madison** — Madison, WI
  Ph.D., Political Science — *Aug 2024 – 2029 (Expected)*
  Dissertation Project – *Optimal Inefficiency: The Political Economy of Why So Few Firms Trade*
  Committee: Jon Pevehouse (Chair), Mark Copelovitch, Jessica Weeks, Anton Strezhnev
  Subfields: International Relations, Methodology

  M.S., Applied Statistics (MSAS) — *Expected Fall 2026*
  Supervisor: Professor Sameer Deshpande

- **McGill University** — Montréal, QC

  Master of Arts, Political Science; GPA: 4.0/4.0 — *Aug 2022 – Aug 2024*
  Bachelor of Arts, Political Science (Honours); GPA: 3.96/4.0 — *Aug 2019 – June 2022*
  Minor Concentrations: Langue & littérature françaises; Russian studies

Grants

- **SSHRC Doctoral Dissertation Research Grant** — $40,000 CAD x3
  2026 – 2029
- **Experimental Politics Workshop Pilot Grant Competition** — $500 USD
  Project: IGO Informality as an Ingress for Lobbying — *2025*
- **SSHRC Canada Graduate Scholarship-Master's (CGSM)** — $17,500 CAD
  2022 – 2023
- **CÉCD-CSDC Students and Postdoctoral Research Grant** — $2,500 CAD
  Project: Latin American Populism and Government Confidence — *2023*

Awards

- **Mildred Potter Hovland Prize** — Value: $750 USD
  Awarded for the best article published in or submitted to a journal by a UW–Madison graduate student — *2026*
- **Allen Oliver Gold Medal**
  Awarded to the graduating student in the department of political science with the highest cumulative GPA. — *2022*
- **Dean's Honour List**
  Awarded to students with GPAs in the top 10th percentile within the department. — *2019 – 2022*
- **Principal's Student-athlete Honour Roll**
  Awarded for maintenance of above a 3.5 GPA while competing for a varsity athletic team. — *2019 – 2021; 2023 – 2024*
- **Alexander MacKenzie Scholarship in Political Science** — Value: $1,000 CAD x 2
  Awarded to 2 students on the basis of excellence within political science examinations. — *2020; 2021*

Research

Working Papers

Governance with Illegitimate Partners. Working Paper || Pre-analysis Plan

Restoring Trust in Unequal Societies, with Leo Baccini (McGill) and Paula Rettl (Harvard). Working Paper || Pre-analysis Plan

Corporate Capture Diplomacy: How States use Sovereign Wealth Funds to Exert Influence Abroad, with Andrew Fairley (UW–Madison) Working Paper

Ongoing Projects

Optimal Inefficiency: The Political Economy of Why So Few Firms Trade (Dissertation project)

Threat of Variety: Product Differentiation, Threat Perception and Economic Competition

Climate Policy in the World Health Assembly with Tana Johnson (UW–Madison)

Published

Hicks, John, Bondi, Arianna, Gareau-Paquette, Thomas, and Patterson, Scott. 2024. "Reproducing *Do Policymakers Listen to Experts? Evidence from a National Survey of Local and State Policymakers* (Lee 2022)," *I4R Discussion Paper Series* 186, The Institute for Replication (I4R). [View Online]

Policy Reports

Shirley, Tom, Hicks, John, Keller, Matthew, Morales Lopez, Oscar Josue, and Yerushalmi, Matthew. "Equitable Economic Recovery: Options for the City of Stamford to Support All Communities in the Next Phase of Recovery." (2021). [View Online]

Presentations

- **International Political Economy Society**
  Corporate Capture Diplomacy: How States use SWFs to Exert Influence Abroad *2026*
- **American Political Science Association Annual Meeting**
  Illegitimate Partners *2026*
- **Environmental Politics and Governance Annual Conference**
  Climate Policy in the World Health Assembly *2026*
- **American Political Science Association Annual Meeting**
  Populism and Trust in Political Institutions: Evidence from Latin America *2025*
  Panel: "Inequality and Distributive Politics in Latin America"
- **Jean Monnet Centre of Excellence Research Workshop, Carleton University**
  War Fatigue in Europe? Explaining selective decline in support for Ukraine Aid *2024*
  Panel: "War as a Unifying and Disunifying Force for the EU"
- **International Political Economy Society**
  Populism and Trust in Political Institutions: Evidence from Latin America *2024*
- **Nordic Political Science Association Congress**
  Reconsidering Generational Patterns of Public Support for Democratic Deconsolidation *2024*
- **Canadian Political Science Association Annual Conference**
  Who opposes democratic backsliding and why: The case of the Israeli judicial reforms *2024*
- **Toronto Political Behavior Workshop**
  Democratic Backsliding in Israel? How Israelis React to the Coalition's Attempt to Overhaul the Judicial System *2023*

Experience

- **Project Assistant to Tana Johnson (UW–Madison)** Madison WI
  Aug 2025 – May 2026
  - Provided research assistance for a study on international negotiations in the World Health Organization.
  - Created original dataset of all World Health Assembly negotiation transcripts. Dataset comprises over 21,000 individual speaker turns, webscraped from official records, cleaned and translated into English.
  - Employed quantitative text analysis and natural language processing.

- **Research Assistant to Leo Baccini (McGill)** Montréal QC
  2022 – 2025
  - Supported project on attitudes towards Artificial Intelligence and changes in the economy among US and Mexican voters in collaboration with Katja Kleinberg (SUNY Binghamton) and Stephen Weymouth (Georgetown). Programmed, scripted and analyzed online pilot survey.
  - Provided scripting for complementary in-the-field RCT on Vietnamese citizens' attitudes toward AI's labor market effects, in collaboration with Edmund Malesky (Duke) and the UNDP [Vietnamese RCT ultimately not fielded due to Vietnamese budget cancellation].
  - Provided survey programming and running for experiment on attitudes towards inflation and government responses, co-authored with Mattia Guidi (Siena) and Arlo Poletti (Trento)
  - Provided research assistance for a study of generational effects in American political and economic attitudes, co-authored with Stephen Weymouth (Georgetown). Provided observational quantitative analysis of Age-Period-Cohort models.
  - Assisted with data analysis during R&R for study on the effect of refugee migration shocks on European workers. Paper published in *International Organization*.
  - Supported political economy project on inflationary effects on the 2022 US midterm election. Provided data management, data model visualization, and survey experiment writing, programming, and distribution. Paper published in *British Journal of Political Science*.

- **Research Assistant to Dietlind Stolle (McGill)** Montréal QC
  April 2023 – Aug 2024
  - Collaborated on analysis of cross-European survey data on attitudes toward the Russian invasion of Ukraine and international policy responses. Analyzed data using linear regression, data visualization and survey experiments. Contributed to redesign of new questions for subsequent survey waves. Co-authoring papers on specific explanations of public opinion in Bulgaria, Romania, and Greece, and generalized papers on topics such as cross-national cleavages on Ukraine aid.
  - Collaborated on studies regarding Israel's current democratic backsliding and public reactions. Implemented an original 2-wave survey featuring multiple vignettes and conjoint experiments to capture a rolling cross-section of responses. Co-authoring papers on partisan cleavages in support of judicial reforms and affective polarization, among other topics.

Instruction

- **University of Wisconsin–Madison**
  Teaching Assistant
  - **PS 812: Introduction to Statistical Methods in Political Science (Graduate) [Fall 2026]**: Prepared and taught coding labs for first-year Ph.D. students. (Instructor: Anton Strezhnev)
  - **PS 348: Analysis of International Relations [Spring 2025]**: Prepared and taught 3 discussion sections with a total of 48 undergraduate students. (Instructor: Lisa Martin)
  - **PS 373: Introduction to Survey Research [Fall 2024]**: Prepared and taught 3 discussion sections with a total of 51 undergraduate students, demoing survey design and related statistical analysis. (Instructor: Ethan vanderWilden) [Course Evaluation Report]

- **McGill University**
  Teaching Assistant
  - **POLI 666: Causal Inference (Graduate) [Winter 2024]**: Taught weekly labs for graduate students and created original materials for lab sessions alongside grading. (Instructor: Aaron Erlich) [Course Evaluation Report]
  - **POLI 618: Quantitative Analysis (Graduate) [Fall 2023]**: Taught weekly lab for graduate students on methods and data analysis in R, assisted students with, assignments and marked student work. (Instructor: Aaron Erlich) [Course Evaluation Report]

Service

- **Refereeing Activity in Academic Journals**

  Reviewer for: *Political Behavior*

Non-academic Experience

- **Carnegie Endowment for International Peace** Washington, DC (Remote)
  Consultant *Feb 2024 – April 2025*
  - **Mapping the Global Information Environment**: Contracted as a consultant on project developing a framework for studying national information ecosystems. Providing analysis of the availability of data to study ecosystems and statistical consulting on viability of methodological options.
- **City of Stamford Department of Economic Development** Stamford, CT (Remote)
  Economic Development Analyst *Jun 2019 – Aug 2021*
  - **Equitable Economic Recovery for the City of Stamford**: Co-authored postpandemic economic recovery report focusing on equity, inclusion, and human capital development. Integrated analysis of city procurement data, community surveying, international case studies and research on industry best practices. Assisted with data analysis of local economic trends and prospects as part of the city's reopening plan following COVID-19-imposed economic constraints.

Volunteering

- **McGill University** Montréal, QC
  Russian Language Department Tutor *Oct 2022 – April 2024*
  - Provided one-on-one and group tutoring to undergraduate students within the Russian language program.
- **Integrated Refugee and Immigrant Services** New Haven, CT
  Health Literacy Intern *July 2020 – Sept 2021*
  - Facilitated interactive online health education classes for immigrant families, assisted with client outreach, organized sewing machine donation drive to supplement client incomes through sales and provided French-language translation services.

Skills

- **Programming**: R, LaTeX, Qualtrics, Stan, Git, Java, Python
- **Languages**: English (native), French (fluent), Russian (intermediate proficiency)